Welcome to *Flipside.*

Flipside is a mixtape maker for the music you own. Pick a C60 or a C90, fill Side A and Side B, write the label by hand, and give it to someone. It runs on your phone or computer and plays from your Plex server. Powered by myStereo.



THE SHORT VERSION

- **Open it:** `ownyourmedia.club/flipside/app`, then add it to your Home Screen.
- **Sign in to Plex,** or try the demo songs first.
- **Make a tape:** press `REC`, or plan one on the **Sketch Pad**.
- **Send it** to someone on your Plex server. The songs stay a surprise until they've heard it all.
- **Tell BC what happened:** Menu › Alpha › Send Feedback.

Thank you.

You're one of the first people to make a tape on Flipside, and that means a lot. It's an alpha, so things will break, words will be confusing, and some buttons will be too small. That's exactly what I need to hear about. Every note you send makes it better for the next person, and for the person you make a tape for.

– BC

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1 · GETTING STARTED

Five minutes from nothing to a tape.

1. **Put it on your Home Screen. iPhone:** open `ownyourmedia.club/flipside/app` in Safari, tap Share, then Add to Home Screen. **Android:** open it in Chrome, tap ⋮, then Add to Home screen or Install app. On a computer, just open the link.

2. **Say hello.** The first time it opens, a welcome card on the deck walks you through it. You can see it again in Menu › Alpha › Welcome Screen.

3. **Sign in to Plex** from the welcome card, or Menu › Settings › Music Sources › Plex. No Plex handy? Choose the Demo Library and try everything with sample songs.

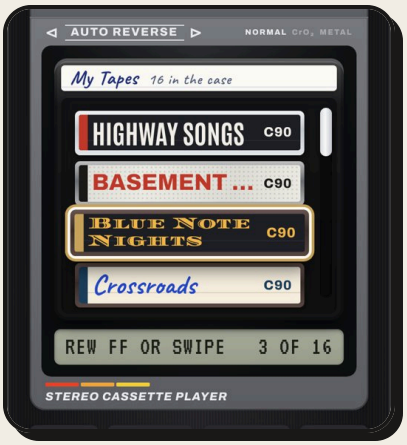
2 · THE CASSETTE DECK

All buttons, no screens.

REC	Starts a new tape.
STOP/EJECT	Stops the tape. Press again to open the door: your tapes stand in a carrying case. Swipe or use REW and FF to look; tap one to lift it out, tap again to load it.
PLAY/PAUSE	Plays or pauses. The reels turn and the song playing is written on the tape.
REW FF	Tap to jump 15 seconds; hold to wind, with the sound of the tape.
FLIP	Turns the tape over to the other side.
☰ SONGS	The small button in the tape window. Opens the track list, written on the J-card. Tap a song to play from there.
Menu	Turns the player over: your music, mixtapes, the Sketch Pad, the Label Maker, settings and the Alpha menu. DECK turns it back.



The welcome card, first launch



The door open: your tapes in the case

3 · MAKING A TAPE

When a side is full, it's full.

1. Press **REC**. Name the tape (up to 40 letters) and pick its length: **C60** (30 minutes a side), **C90** (45 a side) or No Limit.

2. Pick songs anywhere in your library. Every song shows its length; songs too long for the room left are crossed out. Side B fills when Side A is full.

3. Choose **Stop Recording** when you're done. **Arrange Songs** puts them in order: pick one up, turn the knob or tap where it goes, press again to drop it. **+ A Song You Don't Own** saves a spot with links to buy it; add it to Plex and it fills in by itself.

4 · PLANNING A TAPE

The Sketch Pad: plan before you press REC.

A great tape is planned before it's recorded. Menu › **Sketch Pad** › + New Sketch, and it teaches the craft as you go.

Story Arc

Pick a shape: the Classic Arc, Road Trip, For a Crush, Party, Heartbreak, or Bright Side, Late Side. Or build your own beats. Each beat explains its job ("Opener: say hello").

The Crate

The maybe pile. Grab anything that might fit, in any order, no time limit. Then move the keepers into the **Running Order**, under the beat where they belong.

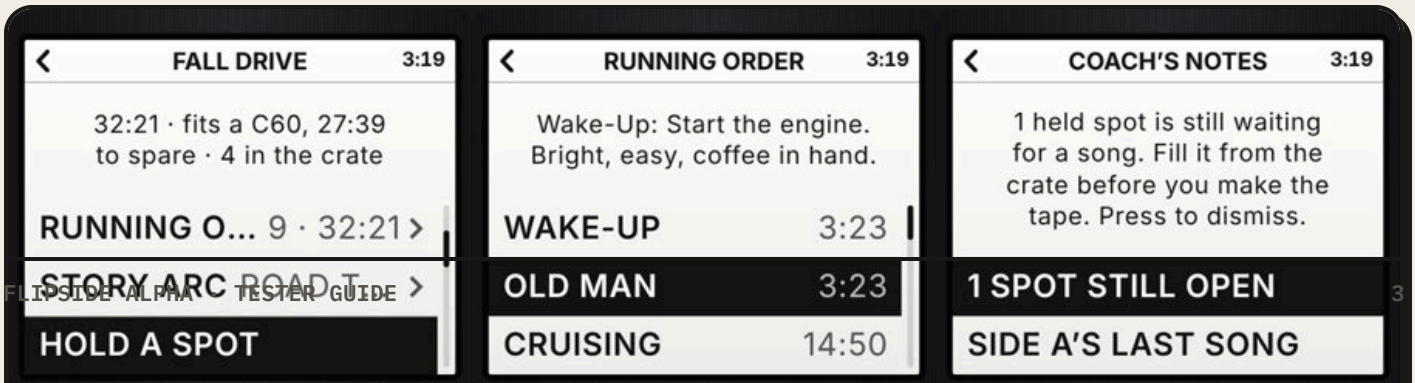
Hold a Spot · Why It's Here

Hold room for "something slow, about 4 minutes" before you know the song. Add a note to any song about why it made the tape.

The Mixtape Coach

Gentle notes on the rules of thumb: an artist twice in a row, a long opener, the song before the flip. Dismiss any note, or turn the coach off in Settings.

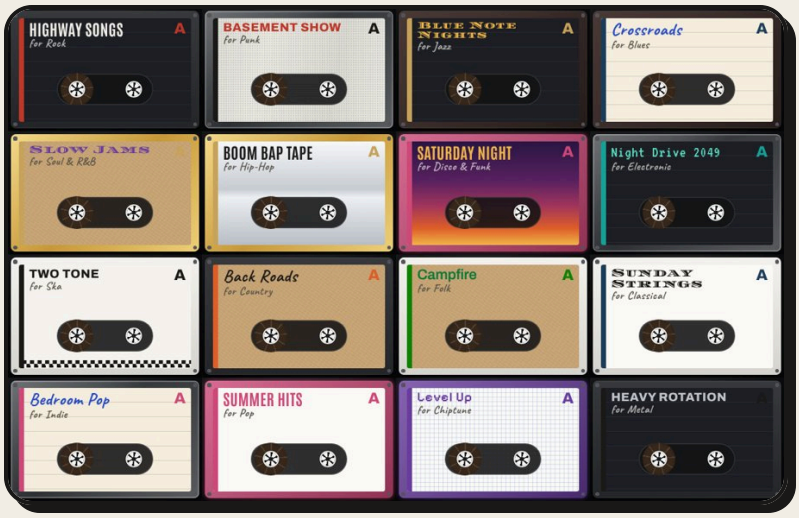
The sketch always shows whether the order fits a C60 or a C90. When it's right, **Make It a Tape**. New to this? Read **The Art of the Mixtape** in the Sketch Pad, or at `ownyourmedia.club/flipside/art`.



5 · DRESSING IT UP

The Label Maker.

Menu › **Label Maker**, or **Design the Label** on any tape. **Music Themes** dress a tape in one press: Rock, Punk, Jazz, Blues, Soul & R&B, Hip-Hop, Disco & Funk, Electronic, Ska, Country, Folk, Classical, Indie, Pop, Chiptune, Metal. Or pick your own **paper**, **shell** (clear, smoke, white, neon, gold), **stripe**, **pen** and **ink**; the label changes as you scroll. Stuck? **Surprise Me**.



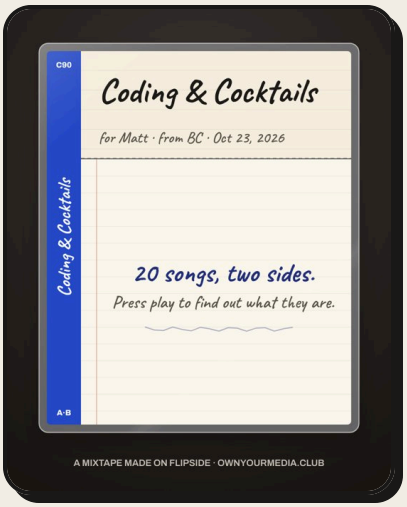
6 · SENDING AND RECEIVING

Give it away.

1. Load a tape and press **SEND MIXTAPE** (or Send Mixtape on the tape's menu).

2. **Song list: Surprise** (the default) keeps the songs secret until they've heard the whole tape. **Shown** writes every song on the card.

3. Pick a person on your Plex server (share your Plex music library with them first). Your share sheet opens with a picture of the tape and the link. On a computer, the picture downloads and Mail opens.



The card they get (Surprise)

When someone sends you a tape

Tap the link, choose **See the Card** or **Add It to My Tapes**. It's a surprise: while it plays, only the current song is written on the tape, and the track list says "keep listening…". Hear it all, both sides, and the song list is yours.

7 · ANALOG MODE

Flipside, anywhere. No signal needed.

Menu › Settings › **Analog Mode**. With it on, every tape lives on your phone and plays with no signal: on a plane, up north, in the basement.

- **Recording really records:** each song you add is copied onto the phone.
- Tapes sent to you **dub when you add them**. Tapes not on the phone yet look faded with a DUB tag; press PLAY with a signal to dub one, or use **Dub All My Tapes**.
- **Dub on Wi-Fi.** A full C90 is about 90 MB at Space Saver and 220 MB at High; ten tapes take about 1–2 GB.
- Add Flipside to your Home Screen first, so your phone keeps the tapes.

8 · ON A COMPUTER

Open the link in a browser and choose **Switch to Desktop Mode**. The deck fills the window in your deck color, the door opens to a tape case you can scroll or drag, and while you record (or sketch) a panel on the right lets you drag songs into order.

9 · WHAT TO TEST

Here's what I most want to hear about.

Make and play
Fill a C60. Do the keys feel right? Can you swipe through the case and load a tape?

Plan one first
Sketch a tape with a story arc. Was the coach helpful or annoying?

Send a surprise
Did the picture and link come through in Messages or Mail? Did the songs stay hidden on their end?

Analog Mode
Dub a tape on Wi-Fi, then play it in airplane mode. How long did the dub take?

Dress it up
Try a Music Theme and build your own label. Does it look right everywhere?

Your phone
iPhone or Android, Home Screen or browser: anything cut off, too small or hard to tap?

10 · TELL BC

Feedback, known limits and quick fixes.

Menu › Alpha › Send Feedback. Pick “Something broke,” “An idea” or “I love this.” Leave **Include device details** checked; it tells me which phone, version and settings you had. No mail app? Write to **bc@runawayanchor.com**. Menu › Alpha also has What to Test, What’s New and this guide’s little sibling, the Quick Start.

Known limits in this alpha

- Sketches stay on the device you made them on. Tapes sync through Plex; sketches don’t yet.
- Your friend hears your tape from your server, so you need to share your Plex music library with them first.
- Rearranging a tape resets its “pick up where you left off” spot.
- Very wide pens (like Fancy) can still get cut off on a tape spine.

Quick fixes

First PLAY is silent	Phones only start sound after a tap. Press PLAY again; check the volume and the iPhone ring switch.
Can’t reach Plex	Make sure your server is on with Remote Access turned on, then Settings › Music Sources › Plex › Reconnect.
Tape missing on another device	Mixtapes › Sync with Plex on both devices, signed in to the same server.
Friend can’t play your tape	Share your Plex music library with them, then send it again.
“Keep listening…”	It’s a surprise tape. Hear the whole thing and the songs appear.
A tape looks faded	Analog Mode: it isn’t on your phone yet. Press PLAY with a signal to dub it.
Android Back	Back steps out of menus first; on the deck with nothing open, it leaves the app.
Icon looks old	Remove Flipside from your Home Screen and add it again. Your sign-in and tapes stay.

Links

App: **ownyourmedia.club/flipside/app** · User’s Guide: Menu › Settings › User’s Guide · The Art of the Mixtape: **ownyourmedia.club/flipside/art**

Who are you making a tape for?

Thanks again for being here. Now go make someone a mixtape.